

LENANA SCHOOL 2025 PREDICTION



POSSIBLE KCSE EXAM

ENGLISH

(Comprehension, Literary Appreciation and Grammar)

101/2

PAPER 2

TIME: 2½ HOURS

NAME.....

SCHOOL..... SIGN.....

INDEX NO..... ADM NO.....

Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education.

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- a) Write your **name** and **index number** in the spaces provided above.
- b) Sign and write the **date of examination** in the spaces provided above.
- c) Answer **all** the questions in this paper.
- d) All your answers **must** be written in the **spaces provided** in the question paper.

FOR EXAMINER'S USE ONLY

QUESTION	MAX SCORE	SCORE
1	20	
2	25	
3	20	
4	15	
TOTAL SCORE	80	

COMPREHENSION (20 MARKS)

1. Read the following passage and then answer the questions that follow.

At the head of the Court is a high seat where the judge sits. Down below it is a table for officers of the court, and to the left and to the right of the table are other seats. Some of these seats form a block that is enclosed, and they are for the jury if there is a jury. In front of the table are other seats, arranged in arcs of circles, with curved tables in front of the seats, and it is there that the lawyers sit. And behind them is the dock, with a passage leading to some place that is underground, and from this place that is underground will be brought the men that are to be judged. At the back of the court there are seats rising in tiers, those on the right for Europeans, those on the left for non Europeans, according to the custom.

You may not smoke in this court, you may not whisper or speak or laugh. You must dress decently, and if you are a man, you may not wear your hat **unless such is your religion**. This is in honour of the judge and in honour of the King whose officer he is; and in honour of the law behind the judge, and in honour of the King whose officer he is; and in honour of the law behind the judge, and in honour of the people behind the law. When the judge enters you will stand, and you not sit till he is seated. When the judge leaves you will stand, and you will not move till he has left you. This is in honour of the judge, and of the things behind the judge.

For to the judge is entrusted a great duty, to judge and pronounce sentence even sentence of death.

Because of their high office, judges are called Honourable, **and precede most other men** on great occasions. And they are held in great honor by men both white and black. Because the land is a land of fear, a judge must be without fear, so that justice may be done according to the law; therefore a judge must be incorruptible.

The judge does not make the law. It is the people that make the law. Therefore, if a law is unjust, and if the judge judges according to the law, that is justice, even if it is not just.

It is the duty of a judge to do justice, but it is only that the people that can be just. Therefore, if justice be not just, that is not to be **laid at the door of the judge**, but at the door of the people, which means at the door of the white people, for it is the white people that make the law.

In South Africa men are proud of their judges, because they are incorruptible. Even the black men are proud of their judges, because they believe they are incorruptible. Even the black men have faith in them, though they do not always have faith in the law. In a land of fear this incorruptibility is like a **lamp set upon a stand**, giving light to that are in the house.

(Adapted from *Cry, the Beloved Country* by Alan Paton)

QUESTIONS

a) What factors determine where you may sit near the front of the court? (2 marks)

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b) What does the seating arrangement at the back of the court reveal about the society? (2 marks)

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c) Certain rules must be strictly observed inside the court. What would non – observance of the rules imply? (2 marks)

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d) Why must a judge be fearless? (2 marks)

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e) How have judges in South Africa earned respect and admiration? (2 marks)

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f) Although the judge has great responsibilities and power, he has limitations. What are his limitations? (4 marks)

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g) What does the second last paragraph reveal about the status of the black people? (2 marks)

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h) Explain the meaning of each of the following expressions as used in the passage

i) Unless such is your religion (1 mark)

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ii) and precede most other men. (1 mark)

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iii) Laid at the door of the judge. (1 mark)

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iv) a lamp set upon a stand (1 mark)

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2. Read the excerpt below from doll's house and answer the questions that follow.

Mossi: (*Pacing about on the stage. Turns to face the principal and Nicole*) I am afraid we may not continue with this thing. Oh, I have already forgotten what you are calling it.

Pirro: (*Looking rather disappointed*) But why, Your Worship? This is a blessing for our country.

Mossi: Don't you see it? It might turn out to be a platform for misinformation, lies and witchhunt. You see, last year someone spread a rumour that I had died. He just sent a text message on some social media and it spread like a wild bush fire. And do you know I almost actually died? During that time, I accidentally swallowed a whole toothpick!

Ramdaye: Oh, yes. I see the risk. They might spread another rumour on this platform! And you might swallow another toothpick! Yes, you will!

Basdeo: (*To Mayor*) The way I see it, that App will be a people's platform! And it will have far-reaching implications whether you launch it or not.

Mossi: (*Casting a stern look at Mr Basdeo*) I need time to think about it. I will launch it at my own convenient time. (*Turning to Nicole and the principal*) There are no two ways for now. Halt any

activities regarding that thing until my office gives further guidance. (*Ramdaye nods in approval.*)

Other guests exchange knowing glances in silence.

Narine: Your Worship, the President of the Republic is scheduled to officially launch the App at the national level early next year when school reopen. We presently have some ongoing activities in preparation for it. I doubt whether this process can be stopped.

Harvester: (*Looking at the Principal and Nicole alternately*) Is that so?

Mossi: (*Looking at the principal*) The President?

Narine: Yes, Sir.

Ramdaye: Why have you kept as in the dark about this?

Narine: The Mayor's office has been duly informed, Sir.

Mossi: (*Lookingg at Narine*) Oh yes, I remember! But you never explained what kind of thing it was! No, you still have to stop it!

Pirro: I think that is beyond their powers, Your Worship.

Mossi: (*Looking at Pirro*) This thing we are talking about is a school project under their control! (*Turning to face the Principal*) It is, therefore, within your powers to find a way around it. (*Pauses, then turns to face Nicole*) Think about it. You are at the centre of it! Figure out a way... like writing to the Ministry of Education indicating that there are some fundamental errors in it that you need to attend to... get what I mean?

Nicole: I am afraid, Your Worship, the assessment of the innovations was done by senior officers at the Ministry of Education. Experienced software engineers were also involved. It passed all the tests, and no errors were found.

QUESTIONS

1. Place this excerpt in its immediate context.

(4 marks)

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2. Discuss two themes raised in the excerpt.

(4 marks)

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3. From this excerpt and elsewhere in the play, why does Mayor Mossi refuse to launch the App?
(2 marks)

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4. Comment on the character of Mossi in this excerpt. (2 marks)

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5. From elsewhere in the play, how does Mossi try to stop the App from operating? (2 marks)

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6. Give reasons why the App is error-proof. (2 marks)

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7. Identify and illustrate two aspects of style used in the excerpt. (4 marks)

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8. Think about it. (Add a question tag)

(1 mark)

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9. Explain the meaning of the following expressions as used in the excerpt.

(4 marks)

a. Far-reaching implications –

b. Halt –

c. Kept us in the dark –

d. Figure out a way -

3. POETRY (20 MARKS)

Read the following poem and answer the questions that follow.

WHEN I WAS ONE – AND – TWENTY

When I was one – and- twenty

I heard a wise man say,

“Give crowns and pounds and guineas

But not your heart away;

Give pearls away and rubies

But keep your fancy free”

But I was one – and- twenty,

No use to talk to me

When I was one- and- twenty

I heard him say again’

“The heart out of the bossom

Was never given in vain;

“Tis paid with sighs a – plenty

And sold for endless rue.”

And I am two – and – twenty,

And oh, ‘tis true, tis true.

(A.E Housman)

QUESTIONS

a) Who is the speaker in this poem? (3 marks)

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b) What advice does the wise man give to the speaker? Does the speaker follow the advice? Explain. (3 marks)

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c) How much time has passed between the first and second stanza? Explain (2 marks)

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d) Identify and illustrate the features of style used in the poem. What does the poet achieve by using them? (6 marks)

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e) Explain the meaning of the following lines. (2 marks)

But I was one and twenty

No use to talk to me

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f) Describe the tone of the poem. (2 marks) _

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g) Rewrite the following lines in your own words: (2 marks)

Tis paid with sings a – plenty

And sold for endless rue

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4. GRAMMAR (20 MARKS)

A] Change the following sentences into direct speech. (2 marks)

i) He said that when he saw them they were playing squash.

ii) The Pupils said that they wished they did not have to take exams.

B] Fill in the black space with the appropriate prepositions. (3 marks)

i) Cat jumped _____the mantel piece

ii) The cook dipped the cup_____ the porridge.

iii) Some students were sent home for going _____the perimeter wall.

C] Write the following sentences according to instructions given. (5 marks)

- i) The Child would have drowned were it not for the quick action taken by the life saver. (Begin: But...)
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ii) Someone is watching us (Rewrite in the passive)

iii) As soon as you see him inform the police (Rewrite using no sooner)

iv) Moses set out for Canaan. His brother accompanied him (Begin: setting.)

v) If he comes, he will not be punished.

D) Explain the meaning of the underlined expressions. (2 marks)

i) Abdi will tidy up the room when pigs begin to fly

ii) My mother has green fingers.

E] Complete the underlined verb to make the appropriate phrasal verb. (3 marks)

i) The immigrant complained about being discriminated because of his race.

ii) I boarded the car and was dropped at the mall.

iii) As she was cleaning her gun, it went and killed her.
